

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Scaling Scrum with Scrum: Learning Objectives

Pre-SSwS plus ten course modules. Pre-SSwS restates the scaling objectives already present in Scrum Mastering I, II, and III and Product Ownership I, II, and III. The ten course modules are the Scaling Scrum with Scrum course. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the SSwS designation.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The handbooks and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work. Completing SSwS does not develop Domain Guides. That happens in the live work of the company, with its people, over months.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in [How 3Back Approaches Learning](#), 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

PRE-SSWS

Pre-SSwS

- P.1 Define Scaling as an Organization's response to increasing demand.
- P.2 Define Scaling as Structure and Governance changes that enable that response.
- P.3 Distinguish scaling by growth from making current Teams more effective.
- P.4 Explain why adding people is a poor first move when the Teams you have are not yet effective.
- P.5 Identify splitting Teams, adding a Product Ownership layer, centralizing for economy of scale, and returning Client contact as common moves.
- P.6 Explain why installing a second system is not scaling Scrum.
- P.7 State why Pre-SSwS must sit for days before the course.

MODULE 01

The claim

- 1.1 Explain "respond to demand at the scale you need" as the purpose of scaling.
- 1.2 Distinguish scaling from continuous improvement of a single team.
- 1.3 Analyze why a scale-ready single-team model can be reused without adding a new framework.

MODULE 02

Context-driven moves

- 2.1 Trace a growth sequence as a series of forced moves, not a target org chart.
- 2.2 Show how an early choice (who stays with the customer, who takes the work) changes later structure.
- 2.3 Decide what evidence would tell you a move was a response to demand rather than a stamp.

MODULE 03

Five problems

- 3.1 Align what should be done, and who does it.
- 3.2 Align how the work is done.
- 3.3 Separate centralizing for economy of scale from centralizing by habit.
- 3.4 Decide when work must be decentralized again.
- 3.5 Assess how change is being managed so one person is not the bottleneck.

MODULE 04

Teams of teams

- 4.1 Distinguish Team, Pod, and Group as used in this course.
- 4.2 Explain why the result of scaling is often a team-of-teams.
- 4.3 Map one real organization (the learner's or a worked example) onto those building blocks without forcing a template.

MODULE 05

Leadership and flow

- 5.1 Explain what a leadership or flow team owns: what is next, and who does it.
- 5.2 Distinguish a leadership team's backlog from a production team's backlog.
- 5.3 Analyze what breaks when one person tries to hold all flow decisions.

MODULE 06

Communication across teams

- 6.1 Explain why coordination by the teams is preferred to a coordinating layer that does not do the work.
- 6.2 Place Scrum-of-Scrums, cross-cutting workgroups, and shared practice in the right problem.
- 6.3 Decide which conversation must happen, who must be in it, and how often.

MODULE 07

Governance

- 7.1 Define Guidance and Objectives as the downward alignment, not a second plan.
- 7.2 Order synchronized Daily Scrums so information can move up without becoming status theater.
- 7.3 Judge a governance rule by whether it produces the right conversation at the right time.

MODULE 08**Reviews and planning at scale**

- 8.1 Explain why every team still plans and still retrospects.
- 8.2 Analyze why a pod or group does not need one giant Sprint Planning.
- 8.3 Decide how Product and Progress Reviews are scheduled when many products and stakeholders will not fit one meeting.

MODULE 09**Transformation**

- 9.1 Distinguish improving how work runs from transforming how work is structured.
- 9.2 Explain why a large organization has to keep re-transforming as demand changes.
- 9.3 Reject a static scaled blueprint as the outcome of this course.

MODULE 10**In this organization**

- 10.1 Apply the five problems to the learner's domain with a Practice Partner.
- 10.2 Choose one structural or governance move and name the evidence that would show it worked.
- 10.3 Separate completing SSWS from developing Domain Guides. The designation is not capability.
- 10.4 Explain how AI in the work can help or hurt a scaling move, and why treating it as a second system is not scaling.

3Back delivers Scaling Scrum with Scrum. SSWS is recognized by the Scrum Guide Organization. Pre-SSWS restates scaling objectives already present in the Scrum Leadership Series. The course modules follow Scrum Handbook: Multi-Team Scrum by Dan Rawsthorne and Doug Shimp.